



Family as a client

Prepared by

Dr/Amany Mohamed Saad

Assistant Professor of Community Health Nursing

Out Lines:

- Introduction.
- Definition of the family.
- Definition of the family as a client.
- Developmental stages of family .
- Classification of the families.
- Characteristics of the family.
- Characteristics of the healthy family.
- Characteristics of the unhealthy family.
- Family roles.

- Functions of the family.
- Family dynamics.
- What influence family dynamics ?
- Factors affecting family health status.
- Types of available community resources for the family.
- Theoretical frameworks for family nursing .
- How family recover from crises.
- Role of the nurse in family care.

Objectives:

At the end of this lecture the students will be able to:-

- Define the family and the family as a client.
- Identify the family developmental stages.
- Recognize the classification of the families.
- Mention the characteristics of the family.
- Clarify characteristics of the healthy family.
- Enumerate family roles.

- List the functions of the family.
- Identify family dynamics.
- Explore what influence family dynamics.
- Explain the factors affecting family health status.
- Identify the types of available community resources.
- Analyze the role of the nurse in family care.
- Apply the family assessment.
- Use family health assessment tools.

Introduction

The family is the smallest unit of a society and, therefore, critical to its development and maintenance.



- Everyone is influenced significantly by their families and the structure, function, and processes within their families. Even individuals who do not interact with their families have been shaped by their families.

- Working in a community setting generally involves working with families. CHN must be there to understand the interactions and dynamics of families so that they can provide appropriate family assessment , planning, intervention and evaluation .

Definition of the family:

The family is a Group of persons joined together by ties of marriage , blood or adoption interacting & communicating with each other in their respective familial and social roles.

Definition of Family as a Client

Is the second approach to family nursing care centers on the assessment of all family members; the family as client is the focus of care.

The family is seen as the sum of individual family members, and the focus concentrates on each individual. Each person is assessed, and health care is provided for all family members. The family unit is not necessarily the primary consideration in providing care.

Developmental stages of the family :-

The family life cycle consists of several developmental stages as:-

1-Beginning Family:- Marriage to birth of first child.



2-Early childbearing:- Women becomes pregnant or the couple decides to adopt.

3-Family with pre-school children:- Oldest child 2-5 years of age.



4- Family with school age children :- Oldest child

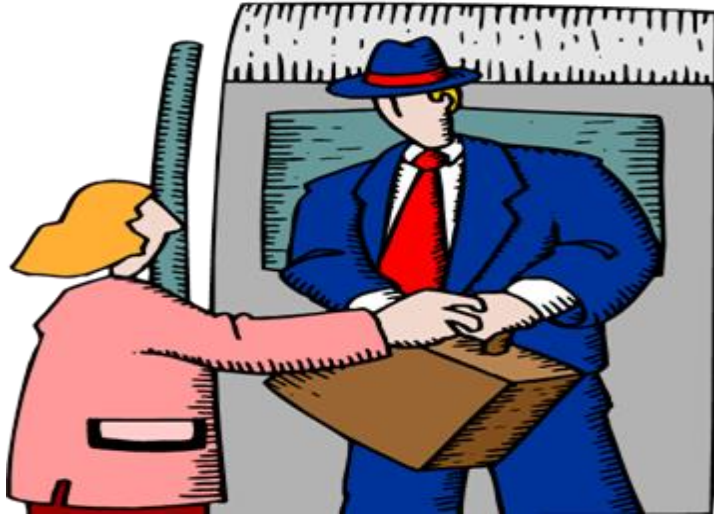
6-12 years of age.

5- Family with teenage children:- Oldest child

13-20 years of age.



6-Launching stage:- Children become adults and leave home.

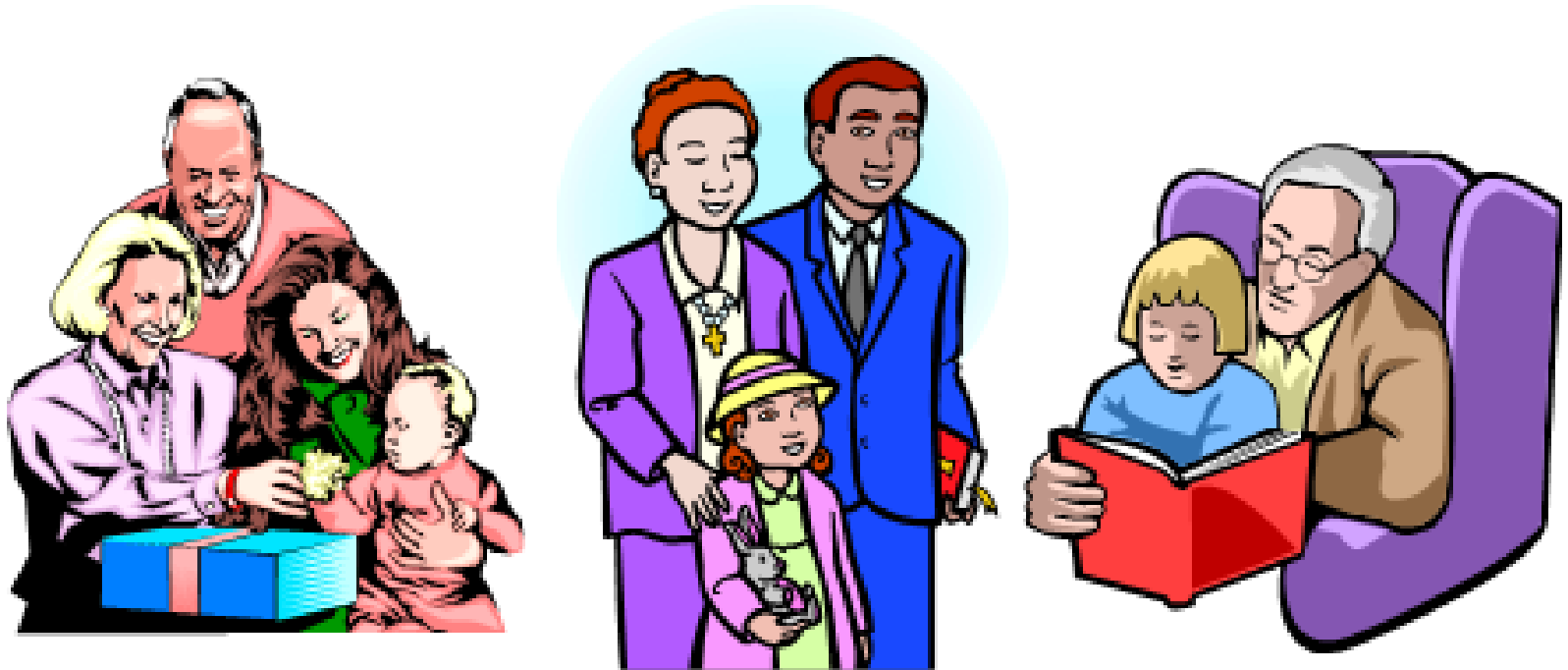


7-Family of middle age :- The family prepares for retirement.

8-Aging or senior stage of life:- Retirement to death.



What is a Family Classification?



Classification of the families according to structure:-

1-Nuclear family:

Consists of husband, wife and children living together only this type common in Egypt in urban area.



2- Extended Family:

Include relatives (grandparents ,aunts, uncles and their children) living in the same house and share in the all items of living e.g food , this type common in rural area because economic reasons.



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3- Dyad Family:

Family consists of 2 people living together usually man and woman without children .Whose children have grown and left home.



4- Blended Family:

Divorced or widowed person with children remarry someone who also has children. These face unique challenges as old loyalties are tested and new relationship are defined .



5- Single-parent Family:

Consists of only one parent with one or more child which is an arrangement resulting from divorce, separation or abandonment death.



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6- Elderly Family Member:

Some people move to warmer climates after retirement as senior citizen housing. These communities offer various level of care depending on need.



7- Cohabitation family:

Composed of heterosexual couples who live together like a nuclear family but remain unmarried (may be temporary or lasting)



8- Adoptive family:

Families who adopt children for various reasons:

- inability to have children biologically
- biological parents are unable to provide care and are willing to have their children adopted.



Characteristics of the Families:

- All families are unique.
- Every family is a small social system.
- Every family has its own cultural, values and rules.
- Every family has structure and certain basic functions.
- Every family moves through stages in its life cycle.

Characteristics of healthy families:

- ❖ There is a facilitative process of interaction among the family members.
- ❖ They enhance individual member development.
- ❖ Their relationships are structured effectively.
- ❖ They actively attempt to cope with the problems.
- ❖ They have a healthy home environment & life style.
- ❖ They establish regular links with broader community.

Characteristics of unhealthy families:

- ❖ Maladaptation or destructive family relationships.
- ❖ Lack of understanding and communication between members.
- ❖ Lack of family decision making and lines of authority.
- ❖ Extreme closeness between husband and his mother or family, or between the wife and her mother or family.

- ❖ Members not maintaining individuality, being too close or too distant with each other.
- ❖ Blaming each other for difficulties.
- ❖ High level of anxiety and insecurity in the home .
- ❖ Lack of creativity and stability.
- ❖ Boundaries between generations not maintained.

Family Roles:

Family members play several roles at the same time.

Eight roles associated with the position of spouse:

- ❖ Provider
- ❖ Housekeeper
- ❖ Child care
- ❖ Socialization
- ❖ Sexual
- ❖ Therapeutic
- ❖ Recreational
- ❖ Kinship

Functions of the Family :-

Biological :-

Reproduction; care and rearing of children, nutrition; maintenance of health and recreation.

Reproduction



Economic :-

Provide adequate financial resources, determine allocation of resources and ensure financial security of members.



Economic

Educational :-

Include teach skills, attitude, knowledge and values in preparation of young for adult life to interact with society.



Psychological :-

Provision of affection, emotional support, development of personalities and ability to form relationships with people outside family circle.

Affection



Socio-Cultural :-

Prepares them to relate effectively with society serves an integrating function between the family and the community, responsible community relationships.



Socialization

- Self-help and accepting help, flexibility of functions and roles, family unity , and cooperation. Family transmits their culture, values, attitude, goals and behavior patterns to their members.

Family Dynamics:

Family dynamics are the patterns of relating, or interactions, between family members. Each family system and its dynamics are unique, although there are some common patterns.

Family dynamics often have a strong influence on the way young people see themselves, others and the world, and influence their relationships, behaviors and their wellbeing.

What influences family dynamics?

Some of the many influences on family dynamics include:

- Nature of the parents' relationship.
- Having a particularly soft or strict parent.
- Number of children in the family.
- Personalities of family members.
- An absent parent.

- A chronically sick or disabled child within the family.
- Events such as an affair, divorce, trauma, death, unemployment , and homelessness.
- Other issues such as family violence, abuse, alcohol or other drug use, mental health difficulties, other disability.

- Family values, culture and ethnicity, including beliefs about gender roles, power or status of family members.
- Nature of attachments in family (i.e. secure, insecure).
- Dynamics of previous generations (parents and grandparents families).

Factors affecting family health status:

- Physical factors.
- Psychological factors.
- Spirituality and religion factors.
- Legal and ethical factors.

Types of available community recourses for the families:

- ❖ M. C. H. Center.
- ❖ Family planning clinic.
- ❖ Governmental hospital.
- ❖ Health promotion program.

Theoretical frameworks for family nursing:-

a-Structure function theory.

b-System theory.

c-Developmental theory.

d- Family crisis.

A theory definition:- It is a systematically interrelated concept or hypotheses that seek to explain or predict phenomena.

Family health theory Example:

Family crises : Crises are experienced in all families.

Two basic types of family crises are:

1-A maturational crisis : Are a normal transition point in which old patterns of communication and old roles must be exchanged for new patterns and roles.

Examples of transitional periods in which maturational crises may occur are adolescence, marriage, and parenthood.

2-A situational crisis : Can occur when the family experiences an event that is sudden, unexpected, and unpredictable. Such events threaten either social integrity leading to disorganization, tension, and severe anxiety.

Examples of situational crises include illness, accidents, death, and natural disasters.

Nursing care of families(role of the nurse)

A-Family Assessment:- Comprehensive family assessment should be the basis for promoting the health of a family.

Several factors influence the assessment of the family:-

- 1- The nurses' perception about the family .
- 2- knowledge and theories.
- 3- Norms and standards, and ability to put the family at ease.

When performing a comprehensive assessment of the family, the nurse does the following:-

- (1) Focus on the family as a total unit
- (2) Ask goal- directed questions
- (3) Collect data over time
- (4) Combine quantitative and qualitative data
- (5) Exercise professional judgment

Data collection categories for family assessment these are:-

1-Family demographics: Composition, socioeconomic status, education, age, occupation, ethnicity and religious of its members.

2- Physical environment data: Geography, climate, housing, social structures, food availability, and dietary patterns.

3- Psychological and spiritual environment:

Relationships, mutual respect, and support,
members self-esteem, spiritual
development, and goals.

4- Family structure and roles: Family

organization, socialization processes,
authority and power patterns.

5- Family function: Ability to carry out appropriate developmental tasks and provide for members' needs.

6- Family values and beliefs: How to raise children, how to make and spend money, and emphasis on education, religion, work, health, and community involvement.

7- Family communication patterns:

Frequency and quality of communication within a family and between the family and its environment.

8- Family decision-making patterns: How decisions are made and implemented

9- Family problem-solving patterns: How the family handles its problems.

10- Family coping patterns: How family handles conflict and life changes, nature and quality of support systems and responses to stressors.

11- Family health behavior: Family health history, health status of members, use of health resources and health beliefs.

12- Family social and cultural patterns: Family discipline and limit setting practices, members creativity, and leadership, family goals ,and development of relationship within and without the family.

Family health assessment tools:-

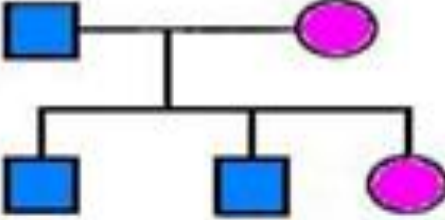
(1) Genogram :-

A genogram is a tool that helps the nurse outline the family's structure. It is a way to diagram the family to view family patterns.

Male 

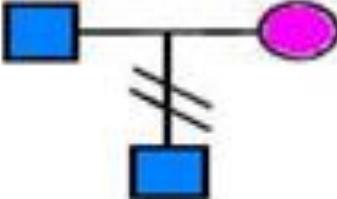
Female 

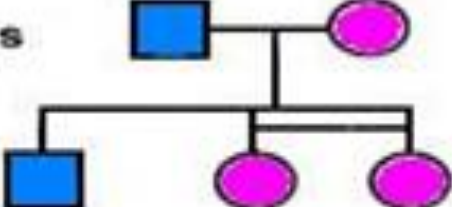
Married 

Children 

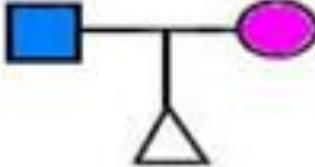
Separated 

Divorced 

Adopted child 

Twins 

Death  

Miscarriage/abortion 

(2)Family health tree:-

The family health tree used to:-

- 1- Provides a way to record data about a family's medical and health histories.
- 2- To know causes of death of deceased family members. Genetically linked diseases including heart disease, cancer, diabetes, hypertension, sickle cell anemia, allergies, asthma, and mental retardation.

3- To know environmental and occupational diseases, psychosocial problems and infectious disease.

4- The family health tree also be used to plan or enhance positive familial influences on risk factors such as diet, exercise, and coping with stress.

Family Health Tree

G-GF
Death ...
Cond. 1 ...

Grandfather
Death (age, cause)
Condition 1 (age)

Grandmother
Death (age, cause)
Condition 1 (age)

Grandfather
Death (age, cause)
Condition 1 (age)

Grandmother
Death (age, cause)
Condition 1 (age)

Dad*
Death (age, cause)
Condition 1 (age)

Mom*
Death (age, cause)
Condition 1 (age)

Me

Siblings

* Record you parent's siblings, too – especially if several of them have/had the same conditions or cause of death

3) Ecomap:-

Ecomap: Is a diagram used to identify the direction and intensity of family relationships between members and community institutions and importance to the family(e.g., schools, workplaces, places of worship).

An ecomap is a tool can be used to:-

(1) Explain family's linkages to their larger environment.

(2) The ecomap illustrates the dynamic of family environment interactions and shows the connections between the family and the world.

(3) The ecomap depicts the important nurturing connections and conflicts, or areas of stress between family members.

(4) An ecomap can also demonstrate the flow or lack of resources,

(5) Therefore it helps point to areas for conflict resolution or to where additional resources are needed.



B - Family intervention:-

Interventions are based on assessment and analysis. They are offered by the nurse to address actual and potential health problems of individuals within the family and the family as a whole.

C - Family evaluation:-

Evaluation is the ongoing process of observing family progress toward meeting goals identified by the nurse and family.

- Evaluation is not merely a terminal phase, but should be ongoing within nursing care. The nurse evaluated responses to her health teaching.
- She encouraged questions and had the women verbally repeat her instructions.

- She also evaluated responses to her counseling and planned for follow up to see if the family members complied with suggestions. For example on subsequent visit, she would ask the woman if she had started her smoking cessation program and she had met with counselor.

Thank you